TEXT ANALYSIS FOR DATA SCIENCE · RESEARCH POSTER

# Trump, Iran & the language of conflict

Six rhetorical frames before, during, and after selected conflict dates


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**Principal finding**

**Victory scores peak on event days.**
**Threat scores decline across windows.**

Victory: 0.673 → 0.761 → 0.700 · Threat: 0.548 → 0.524 → 0.485

| 87 | 26 | 129 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|
| unique posts | conflict start dates | post / date pairs | rhetorical frames |

## 01 Frame the project

**Do rhetorical frames differ around conflict dates?** Political posts mix threats, success claims, and negotiations. Comparing frames helps readers examine public messaging around selected events.

**Task.** Given an Iran-related post, assign six independent frame scores and compare the day before, day of, and day after an event's recorded start date.

## 02 Explain the workflow

1. **Collect & align**
   Prepared public-post CSV + UCDP-derived workbook. Match Eastern Time dates at −1, 0, +1 days.
2. **Prepare**
   Deduplicate by post ID; preserve saved text, case, and punctuation. One pair per post / event date.
3. **Represent & classify**
   BART tokenizer → contextual representations → `facebook/bart-large-mnli` . Six natural-language prompts; multi-label NLI; truncation enabled.
4. **Aggregate**
   Average scores within each date/window, then average those date means. Use every available post.

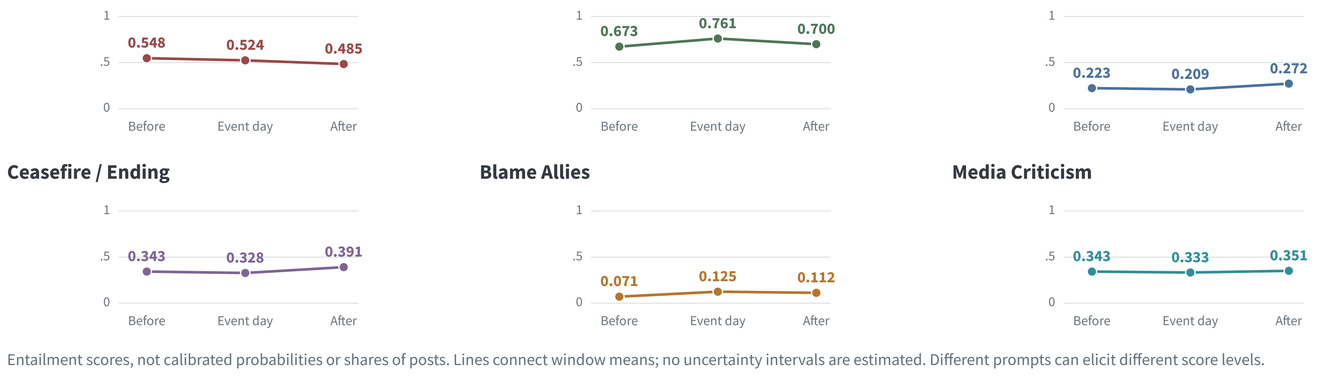
The model sees post text only. Headlines and fatalities do not enter the classifier. One post can score highly on several frames.

## 03 Show the results

### Mean frame score by window

Figure 1 · same 0–1 scale

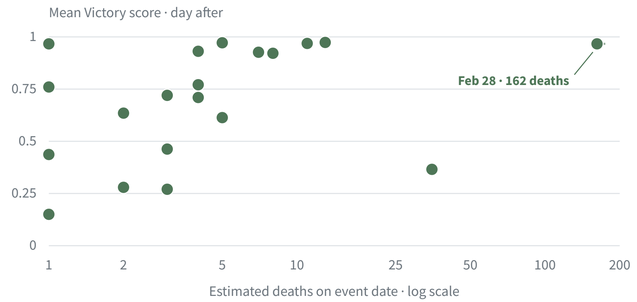
All available posts · 20 / 21 / 21 contributing dates · 40 / 40 / 49 post-event pairs (before / event day / after)




Entailment scores, not calibrated probabilities or shares of posts. Lines connect window means; no uncertainty intervals are estimated. Different prompts can elicit different score levels.

### Higher next-day Victory scores after deadlier dates

Figure 2 · exploratory




**+0.50** Spearman ρ
**20** event dates

Without the largest date (Feb 28; 162 deaths):
**ρ = +0.43 · 19 dates**

Selected after comparing frames and windows; exploratory, not confirmed. No causation or prediction.

One dot = one event date · Next-day post averages · All 20 eligible dates included

One dot per eligible event date; next-day post means. Log x-axis; horizontal marks are source low–high death estimates, not confidence intervals. Multi-day totals and windows without posts are omitted. Focus or click a dot for details.

## 04 Evaluate & reflect

Preliminary · human evaluation pending

**Integrity checks passed.** All 87 score IDs join to the corpus; six score columns are finite and in 0–1. Pairs are unique; saved date offsets match.

**Accuracy is untested.** No human gold labels, held-out precision/recall/F1, or evaluated baseline. Integrity checks do not validate rhetorical accuracy.

### A failure mode to investigate

A post praising a military operation scores highly on Ceasefire / Ending without explicitly saying the fighting has ended.

Ceasefire / Ending **0.802**

Inspect source ↗ · Qualitative case, not a gold label.

### Limits & practical implications

Window coverage differs; missing posts are not zero rhetoric. Overlapping windows reuse posts and create dependence.

Same-day dates cannot establish ordering. Linked headlines, missing media, and truncation can distort attribution.

**Use scores to find language for human review.** Human validation and non-event comparisons are needed before stronger claims.

## Inside the corpus

Truth Social · 87 unique posts · chronological excerpts, not a live feed

2026-02-28 · @realDonaldTrump · excerpt

Iran tried to interfere in 2020, 2024 elections to stop Trump, and now faces renewed war with United States:…

2026-02-28 · @realDonaldTrump · excerpt

Khamenei, one of the most evil people in History, is dead. This is not only Justice for the people of Iran, but for all Great Americans, and those people from many…


**Sources & reproducibility.** Project repository, data & notebook · UCDP · BART-MNLI · Matching public-post archive. Upstream snapshot and model revision are unpinned; saved scores were not rerun. UCDP: CC BY 4.0; underlying post rights remain with their owners.


**AI-use statement.** Sean directed the project. The notebook, data, and saved BART scores preceded this poster. OpenAI Codex helped interpret the rubric, aggregate saved scores, and build and verify the poster. Human review and oral defense remain Sean's responsibility; see the repository for the fuller history.